

MUST FOR EVERY STUDENT ... FOR ALL COMPETITIVE EXAMS

ENGLISH MADE SIMPLE!

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MODULE - 19



Indictment : *A formal statement of accusing someone of something.*

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Example :
Former U.S. President
Donald Trump was
indicted for the third
time.

Indictment : *Something that shows a policy, system, society, etc. is bad or wrong.*

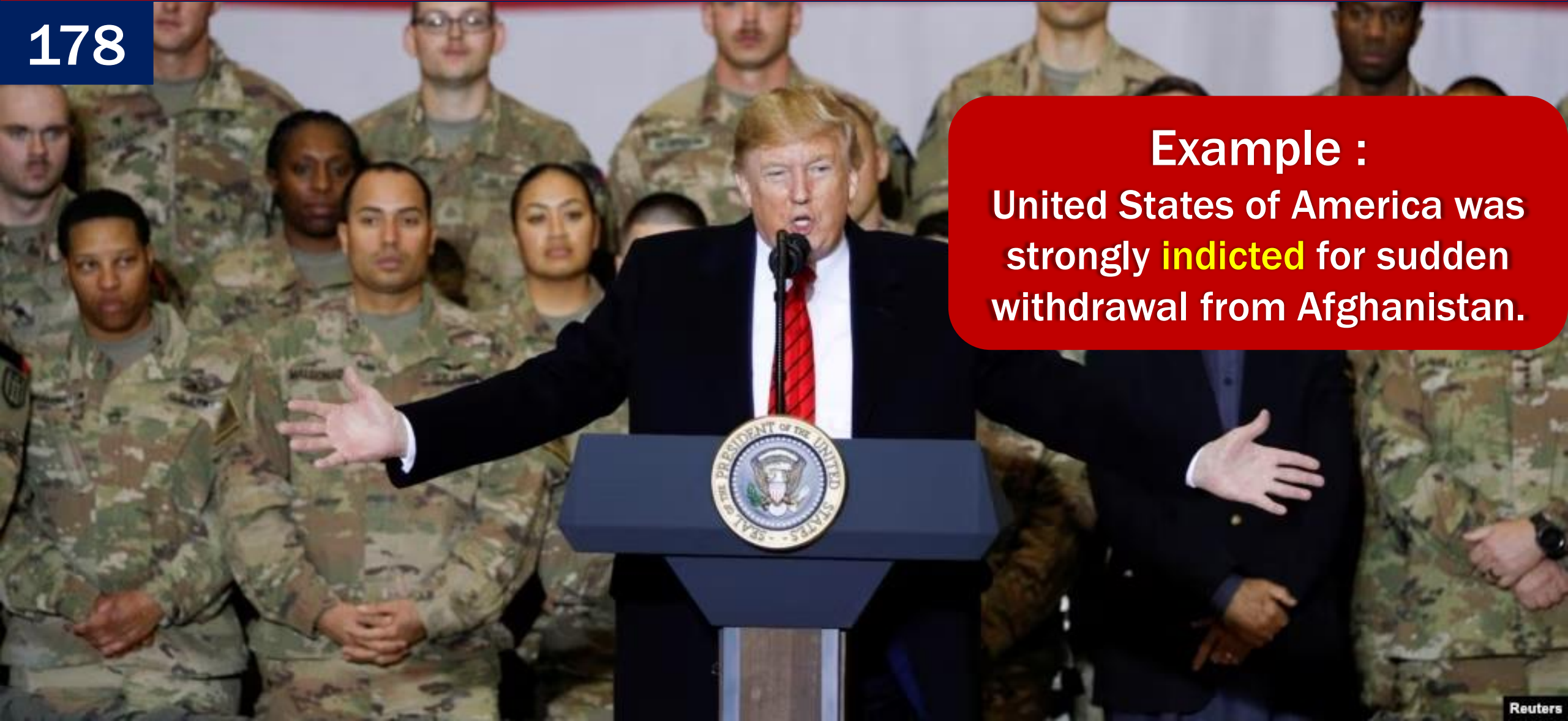
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Example :
Lack of qualitative employment is seen as an **indictment** of the country's economic policy.

Indictment : *A statement that criticizes someone or something strongly for being bad or wrong.*

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Example :
United States of America was strongly **indicted** for sudden withdrawal from Afghanistan.

Uncharted : *Completely new and not previously described or experienced and therefore possibly difficult to deal with.*

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Example :
Young technocrats should take more risks and venture into **uncharted** areas through innovative and deep tech startups.

Uncharted : *An uncharted area has not had a map made of it and has not been described.*

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Example :
Majority of the underground
tunnels and caves are
uncharted.

Front-runner : *Person /organization that is most likely to win something.*

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Example :
XXX is one of the **front-runners**
to win the YYY Lok Sabha
constituency.

Front-runner : *The person/product that seems most likely to succeed.*

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Example :
For the 2024 Lok Sabha Elections, as per various opinion polls, the present incumbent Sri Narendra Modi is much ahead, and he is clearly the **front-runner** for the post of the Prime Minister.

Detractor : Someone who criticizes something/someone, often unfairly.

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Example :
Detractors of Arun claim that his short temper makes him unsuitable for CEO of the company.

adept : *Skilled*

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Example :
Radha is **adept** at
communicating in
colloquial language.

adept : *Having a natural ability to do something that needs skill.*

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Example :
In times of crisis, the CEO must be very **adept** at dealing with the media.

Shoring up : *To make something stronger by supporting it.*

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Example :

The Board of the company devised a meticulous plan, which will enable the company to **shore up** its financial position.

Shoring up : *To stop a wall or building from falling down by supporting it with something.*

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Example :

In due course of time, the boundary walls will become weak, and they need to be **shored up**.



28-09-2023

Drawing the line

Information aids public safety, and
is not a trigger for panic

The year began on a calamitous note with reports that the temple town of Joshimath in the Chamoli district of Uttarakhand was 'sinking' and that cracks had appeared on residential and commercial structures. This prompted a humanitarian crisis with people fleeing and taking refuge in tents and open spaces, fearing that their homes would crumble. A proximate reason for the acceleration in the fissures and cracks was attributed to tunnelling activities from the Tapovan Vishnugad power project being developed by the National Thermal Power Corporation. There were also concerns on whether groundwater depletion, or increased urbanisation that encouraged faulty construction, had reached a point from which disasters had become inevitable. To address all these, the Uttarakhand State Disaster Management Authority had commissioned eight reputed institutions to study the land-subsidence phenomenon from multiple angles. Surprisingly, it banned the public dissemination of information from scientists involved with the institutions on the grounds that satellite imagery pictures – from Indian and international sources – of the subsurface in Uttarakhand were aggravating "panic" and that information was to be shared only after it was "cleared" by the Centre. The net result of this is that despite reports of all institutions being available for months, it took a strong rebuke from the High Court of Uttarakhand last week for the State authorities to make this information public.

Though these reports are technical, they reiterate what has been known about the risks underlying infrastructure development in Uttarakhand. The Central Building Research Institute, Roorkee, for instance, pointed out that 99% of construction in the region did not comply with the mandatory building codes. The National Institute of Hydrology, Roorkee, in its report, said that the network of springs, drainage systems and areas of subsidence may influence land subsidence and there was a need to monitor them. Overall, the tenuous geology made city-like infrastructure projects risky and strict town-planning and construction measures were necessary to minimise the risk from accidents and a loss of lives. While there is a legitimate case for ensuring that citizens in the hill States are not denied basic amenities and the opportunities for material advancement, it is incumbent upon governments to take hard decisions that are sustainable as against those that are aimed to score in the next election. A necessary step is in ensuring that information on the risks is widely disseminated and communicated in a way that it becomes a part and parcel of public life. Independent scientific counsel must form the backbone of policymaking and clear lines must be drawn around the limits to development in the region.

DRAWING THE LINE

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